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Business Analytics Terminology

1) Business Analytics →

Business Analytics is all about making sense of data so business can make smarter decisions. Instead of just looking at numbers, it focuses on turning raw data into meaningful insights that improve performance, uncover opportunities, and help a company stay competitive.

* Example : A retail store may look at last month's sales report and sees that t-shirts are the ones with most sales, it tells then what is happening.

* Source : Evens (2017); McKinsey (2023)

2) Data Analytics →

Data Analytics is the process of examining raw data to identify patterns, trends, and insights that can be used to inform decision. It focuses more on technical data processing.

* Example : Analyzing viewer data to determine the most popular TV programs

* Source : Investopedia (2024); Evens (2017)

3) Business Intelligence (BI) →

Business Intelligence refers to tools and systems used to collect, analyze, and present business data in the form of reports and dashboards.

* Example : Using Power BI to track company performance.

* Source : Tableau (2024); Microsoft (2024)

4) Data-Driven Decision Making →

This is the process of making decisions based on data analysis rather than intuition or personal judgment.

* Example : A company schedules ads during peak viewing time based on data.

* Source : Harvard Business Review (2023)

5) Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) →

KPIs are measurable values that demonstrate how effectively a company is achieving its business objectives.

- * Example : Customer satisfaction score, monthly revenue growth, website conversion rate.
- * Source : Parmenter (2020)

6) Predictive Analytics →

Predictive analytics uses historical data, statistical algorithms, and machine learning techniques to identify the likelihood of future outcomes.

- * Example : Predicting customer churn, forecasting sales demand.
- * Source : Davenport and Harris (2017)

7) Descriptive Analytics →

Descriptive analytics involves summarizing historical data to understand what has happened in the past.

- * Example : Monthly sales reports, website traffic summaries.
- * Source : IBM (2023)

8) Prescriptive Analytics →

Prescriptive analytics recommends actions that can be taken to achieve the best possible outcomes.

- * Example : Recommending optimal pricing strategies, inventory optimization.
- * Source : Gartner (2022)

9) Data Mining →

Data mining is the process of discovering patterns and relationships in large datasets.

- * Example : Market basket analysis, fraud detection.
- * Source : Han, Kamber, and Pei (2011)

10) Data Literacy →

Data literacy is the ability to read, understand, and communicate data effectively.

- * Example : A manager interpreting dashboard insights correctly.
- * Source : Harvard Business Review (2023)

11) Structured Data →

Structured data is organized data stored in rows and columns, making it easy to analyze.

- * Example : Customer data in Excel tables.
- * Source : Investopedia (2024)

12) Unstructured Data →

Unstructured data is data that does not have a fixed format, such as text or multimedia.

- * Example : Videos and social media posts.
- * Source : McKinsey (2023)

13) Data Warehouse →

A data warehouse is a centralized system used to store large volumes of data for analysis.

- * Example : A company storing all sales data in one system.
- * Source : Microsoft (2024)

14) Data Mining →

Data mining is the process of discovering patterns and relationships in large datasets.

- * Example : Identifying customer buying trends.
- * Source : Evans (2017)

15) Data Visualization →

Data visualization is the use of charts and graphs to represent data visually.

- * Example : A bar chart showing viewer distribution.
- * Source : Tableau (2024)

16) Dashboard →

A dashboard is a visual interface that displays key metrics and data in real time.

- * Example : Your BrightTV dashboard.
- * Source : Microsoft (2024)

17) Metric →

A metric is a measurable value used to track performance.

- * Example : Number of viewers.
- * Source : Investopedia (2024)

18) Key Performance Indicator (KPI) →

A KPI is a critical metric that measures how effectively a business achieves its objectives.

- * Example : Monthly subscriber growth.
- * Source : Investopedia (2024)

19) Benchmark →

A benchmark is a standard used to compare performance against others.

- * Example : Comparing sales to industry averages.
- * Source : Statista (2024)

20) Segmentation →

Segmentation involves dividing data into groups based on shared characteristics.

- * Example : Grouping customers by age or location.
- * Source : HubSpot (2024)

21) Conversion Rate →

The percentage of users who complete a desired action.

- * Example : 10% of visitors subscribe.
- * Source : Google Analytics (2024)

22) Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) →

The cost of acquiring a new customer.

- * Example : R100 spent per new customer.
- * Source : Investopedia (2024)

23) Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) →

The total revenue expected from a customer over time.

- * Example : A subscriber pays monthly for 2 years.
- * Source : HubSpot (2024)

24) Churn Rate →

The percentage of customers who stop using a service.

- * Example : 5% of customers cancel monthly.
- * Source : Investopedia (2024)

25) Customer Retention Rate →

The percentage of customers who continue using a service.

- * Example : 95% retention rate.
- * Source : HubSpot (2024)

26) Net Promoter Score (NPS) →

A measure of customer loyalty based on willingness to recommend.

- * Example : Customers rate service from 0-10.
- * Source : Harvard Business Review (2023)

27) Average Order Value (AOV) →

The average amount spent per transaction.

- * Example : R200 per purchase.
- * Source : Investopedia (2024)

28) Sales Funnel →

The stages customers go through before making a purchase.

- * Example : Awareness → Purchase.
- * Source : HubSpot (2024)

29) Marketing Campaign →

A coordinated effort to promote a product or service to a target audience.

- * Example : Launching a new show on BrightTV.
- * Source : HubSpot (2024)

30) Click-Through Rate (CTR) →

The percentage of users who click on a link or ad.

- * Example : 4% CTR on a YouTube ad.
- * Source : Google Analytics (2024)

31) Cost Per Click (CPC) →

The cost paid for each click on an advertisement.

- * Example : R2 per click on a Facebook ad.
- * Source : Investopedia (2024)

32) Return on Investment (ROI) →

A measure of the profit generated compared to the cost of an investment.

- * Example : R500 profit from a R100 ad spend.
- * Source : Investopedia (2024)

33) Impression →

The number of times an ad or content is displayed.

- * Example : 1,000 ad impressions.
- * Source : Google Analytics (2024)

34) Engagement Rate →

The percentage of audience interactions (likes, comments, shares) relative to reach.

- * Example : 8% engagement rate.
- * Source : HubSpot (2024)

35) Reach →

The total number of unique users who see content or ads.

- * Example : 5,000 unique viewers.
- * Source : Hootsuite (2024)

36) Bounce Rate →

The percentage of visitors who leave a website after viewing only one page.

- * Example : 60% bounce rate on a landing page.
- * Source : Google Analytics (2024)

37) Traffic Source →

The origin of a website visitor (e.g., search engine, social media, direct, referral).

- * Example : Visitors coming from Facebook.
- * Source : Google Analytics (2024)

38) Customer Segmentation →

The process of dividing customers into groups based on similar characteristics.

- * Example : Segmenting viewers by age group.
- * Source : HubSpot (2024)

39) A/B Testing →

A method of comparing two versions of a webpage, ad, or content to see which performs better.

- * Example : Testing two different ad headlines.
- * Source : Optimizely (2024)

40) Customer Journey →

The complete experience a customer has with a brand from awareness to purchase and beyond.

- * Example : Awareness → Consideration → Purchase → Loyalty.
- * Source : McKinsey (2023)

41) Lifetime Value (LTV) →

Another term for the total value a customer brings to a business over their lifetime.

- * Example : R2,000 value over 24 months.
- * Source : HubSpot (2024)